CURIOUS SPAROOWS · ENCYCLOPEDIC INDEX · NEEDLE ARTS

CROCHET

How one hook and one string make lace, toys and blankets

Hooks and yarns · stitches with US and UK names · techniques · styles and traditions of the world and India · projects register · history · designers and community · ideas · practical guide

Parts	Sections	Sub-sections	Entries	Register rows
12	28	11	133	46

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How to Use This Booklet

This booklet is a map of crochet: tools and yarns, stitches, techniques, styles and traditions, projects, history, people, ideas and a practical guide.

Every entry has an ID (such as CRO-07.6 for amigurumi). The same ID is the entry's address on curioussparoows.com.

How this booklet is organised

Parts 0 to 11: intro questions, map, tools, stitches, techniques, styles, projects, history and people, ideas, practical guide, reviews, navigation and sources.

Entries (☐): one or two lines each; tick when learned or made.

Registers: stitch names, 24 projects and the timeline.

How to explore it

Step 1. Read Part 0.

Step 2. Learn the six basic stitches (Part 3).

Step 3. Make the first 10 projects in order (Part 9).

Step 4. Explore a tradition, from Irish lace to Narsapur.

Step 5. Tick ☐ and keep a project log.

Our promise

Knowledge belongs to the people who created it. Patterns are described, never copied; designers are credited. Where something could not be verified, we say so instead of guessing.

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PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: HOW CAN ONE HOOK AND ONE STRING MAKE LACE, TOYS AND BLANKETS?

About this Part. This is the doorway to the Crochet section of the website, part of the **Needle Arts** branch with Knitting (KNT), Embroidery (EMB) and Sewing (SEW). One Gateway page, five Leaves and one Recap; each Leaf takes about two minutes, gives its short answer first and ends with a hook to the next question.

CRO-00 The Gateway: How can one hook and one string make lace, toys and blankets?

Web address: /crochet/one-hook-one-string/ · **Keywords:** crochet for beginners, what is crochet, crochet history, crochet stitches, crochet vs knitting

Crochet needs almost nothing: a hook and a length of yarn or thread. Yet with them people make fine lace collars, stuffed toys, warm blankets, bags, rugs, even sculptures. Every crochet piece is built one loop at a time, pulled through another loop, and only one loop is "live" on the hook at any moment. That simple rule is crochet's freedom: you can go in any direction, in rows, in rounds or in free shapes.

This short course asks one question in five steps: **what makes crochet special, and why do people love it?**

By the end you will be able to:

- Say what crochet is and how it differs from knitting.
- Explain why no machine truly crochets.
- Give the main theories of where crochet came from.
- Tell the story of Irish crochet lace and the Great Famine.
- Explain, with evidence, why many people find crochet calming.

CRO-00.01 What is crochet, really?

> **Short answer:** Crochet is making fabric from a continuous strand by pulling loops through other loops with a hooked tool. The word comes from the French *crochet*, "small hook". Unlike knitting, which keeps a whole row of live loops on needles, crochet works one stitch at a time and finishes each before moving on.

Keywords: what is crochet, crochet meaning, crochet vs knitting, crochet vs tatting, crochet hook

How it compares

- **Knitting** (KNT): many live loops on two or more needles; stretchy, thinner fabric.
- **Crochet**: one live loop; thicker, firmer fabric; easy to shape in three dimensions.
- **Tatting**: lace made of knots and rings with a shuttle or needle.
- **Knotting and macramé**: fabric from knots, no hook needed.
- **Nalbinding**: an older looping craft with a single eye-needle and short lengths.

Why it is flexible

Because each stitch is finished, a dropped hook does not unravel a whole row, and you can add stitches anywhere. That is why crochet suits round shapes (granny squares, toys) and freeform art.

> **Remember this:** One hook, one live loop, endless shapes.

Next: Knitting machines are everywhere. Why is there no crochet machine?

CRO-00.02 Why can't a machine crochet the way it knits?

Short answer: Each crochet stitch involves the hook moving in several directions, wrapping yarn and passing through loops at different heights and angles. Machines handle the regular, repeated motion of knitting needles well, but no machine has yet copied true hand crochet. Factory "crochet-look" lace is usually made on warp-knitting or other machines.

Keywords: crochet machine, is crochet handmade, machine knitting vs crochet, crochet look lace

What this means

- **Every crocheted item is handmade.** A crocheted cardigan or toy in a shop was made by a person, often a low-paid worker; ask who made it (CRO-17).
- **Imitations**: "crochet" lace trims are often made on machines that imitate the look.
- **Value**: hand crochet takes hours; a blanket can take 40 hours or more.

Remember this: If it is truly crocheted, a human made it.

Next: Who made it first? Where did crochet come from?

CRO-00.03 Where did crochet come from?

Short answer: Nobody knows for sure. Looping crafts are ancient, but clear evidence of crochet as we know it appears only in the early 1800s in Europe. The first published crochet patterns are usually traced to the Dutch magazine *Penélopé* in 1824. Earlier theories point to Arabia, South America or China, but evidence is thin.

Keywords: history of crochet, origin of crochet, Penelope 1824, shepherd's knitting, tambour embroidery

The theories

- **Arabian origin**, spreading along trade routes (Lis Paludan, *Crochet: History and Technique*, 1995, found no firm proof).
- **South American** puberty-rite adornments, mentioned in some histories.
- **Chinese** three-dimensional dolls.
- **Tambour embroidery**: a hook used to chain-stitch on fabric stretched on a frame, popular in India, Persia and Turkey; some historians think crochet began when people dropped the fabric and worked the chain "in the air" (*crochet in the air*).
- **"Shepherd's knitting"**: slip-stitch crochet in 19th-century Scotland.

What is certain

By the 1840s, crochet pattern books were popular in Europe, and Mlle Riego de la Branchardière published many designs that made crochet lace fashionable.

Remember this: Crochet is younger than knitting in the records, and its birthplace is still a mystery.

Next: In Ireland, crochet was a lifeline. How?

CRO-00.04 How did crochet save families in the Irish famine?

Short answer: During the Great Famine of 1845 to 1852, nuns and charitable women taught girls and women to make crochet lace imitating costly Venetian needle lace. Sold in Britain, Europe and America, it brought cash to families who had lost their potato crop. "Irish crochet" became world-famous.

Keywords: Irish crochet lace, Great Famine crochet, Clones lace, crochet history Ireland, crochet cottage industry

How it worked

- **Teaching**: the Ursuline nuns at Blackrock, Cork, and others ran classes from the 1840s.
- **Motifs**: roses, shamrocks and leaves were made separately and joined with a mesh of chains.
- **Centres**: Clones (County Monaghan) gave its name to "Clones lace".
- **Income**: families sometimes earned more from lace than from farm work; some lace-makers saved enough to emigrate.

Echoes in India

The same story repeats: in 1844, Scottish missionaries are said to have taught crochet in Narsapur, Andhra Pradesh, and it became a livelihood for tens of thousands of women. *Narsapur crochet lace* now has a GI tag (CRO-07).

Remember this: Crochet lace turned skill into survival.

Next: Today people crochet for joy. Why is it so calming?

CRO-00.05 Why is crocheting calming?

Short answer: Repetitive, rhythmic hand movements, a clear goal and a finished object seem to calm the mind. In a 2020 online survey of over 8,000 crocheters, Pippa Burns and Rosemary Van Der Meer found that about 90 per cent said crochet made them calmer, and many used it to cope with anxiety, grief or chronic pain.

Keywords: crochet and mental health, crochet mindfulness, benefits of crochet, crafting and anxiety, textile crafts well-being

What studies say

- **Burns and Van Der Meer** (*Perspectives in Public Health*, 2021): crochet linked with feeling calmer, happier and more useful.
- **Riley, Corkhill and Morris** (2013) on knitting: similar calm and social benefits (KNT-14).
- **Flow**: Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi's idea of absorption in a task that matches your skill.
- **Social crafting**: groups and "crochet-alongs" reduce loneliness.

Honest limits

These are surveys of people who already crochet; they show association, not proof. Crochet complements, never replaces, professional care.

Remember this: Rhythm, purpose and community make crochet a calming craft.

Next: The Recap.

CRO-00.06 Recap: one loop at a time

- **CRO-00.01**: Crochet pulls one loop through another with a hook; one live loop at a time.
- **CRO-00.02**: No machine truly crochets; every real crochet item is handmade.
- **CRO-00.03**: Origins are debated; the first printed patterns appeared in 1824.
- **CRO-00.04**: Irish crochet lace fed families during the Great Famine; Narsapur did the same in India.
- **CRO-00.05**: Crochet is linked with calm and well-being.

Where to go next: the Master Map (Part 1) and the first 10 projects (Part 8). **Quick quiz:** What does *crochet* mean in French? What year were the first printed patterns? Which Indian crochet lace has a GI tag?

PART 1 — THE MASTER MAP OF CROCHET

About this Part. The whole hierarchy on one page. Crochet is one of four sister crafts in the **Needle Arts** branch of Curious Sparoows; shared topics (fibres, colour, care, selling) link across all four.

CRO-01 The hierarchy: from Forest to Leaf

Before you start — CRO-01. The Forest is "Crochet". Its Trees are tools and materials, stitches, techniques, styles and traditions, projects, and the human side (history, people, ideas, practice). **See also:** KNT-01, EMB-01, SEW-01.

☐ **CRO-01.1 Tools and materials**: hooks, yarns, fibres and notions (Part 2).
☐ **CRO-01.2 Stitches**: foundation, basic, textured, post, colourwork, lace and Tunisian (Part 3).
☐ **CRO-01.3 Techniques**: rows and rounds, shaping, joining, finishing, reading patterns (Part 4).
☐ **CRO-01.4 Styles and traditions**: Irish, filet, Tunisian, amigurumi, freeform, tapestry and Indian traditions (Part 5).
☐ **CRO-01.5 Projects register** (Part 6).
☐ **CRO-01.6 The human side**: history and people (Part 7), ideas (Part 8), the practical guide (Part 9), reviews (Part 10).

PART 2 — TOOLS AND MATERIALS

CRO-02 Hooks

Before you start — CRO-02. Hook sizes are best given in **millimetres**, the international standard. The US uses letters and numbers (for example US H-8 = 5 mm); old UK sizes ran backwards (UK 6 = 5 mm). Steel hooks for thread use their own small numbers. Always check the millimetre size.

- ☐ **CRO-02.1 Standard hooks**: aluminium (smooth, cheap), steel (0.5 to 2.75 mm, for thread and lace), wood and bamboo (warm, less slippery), plastic (large sizes).
- ☐ **CRO-02.2 Ergonomic hooks**: thick, soft handles to reduce hand strain.
- ☐ **CRO-02.3 Inline and tapered heads**: inline heads (Bates style) suit some people, tapered (Boye style) suit others.
- ☐ **CRO-02.4 Tunisian (afghan) hooks**: long hooks, often with a cable, to hold many loops (CRO-04.6).
- ☐ **CRO-02.5 Double-ended hooks**: for two-colour reversible Tunisian work ("crochet on the double").
- ☐ **CRO-02.6 Jumbo hooks**: 15 to 25 mm and more, for chunky and arm-style work.
- ☐ **CRO-02.7 Light-up and specialty hooks**: hooks with lights for dark yarn; hairpin forks and broomstick pins (CRO-07).

CRO-03 Yarns, fibres and notions

- ☐ **CRO-03.1 Yarn weights (Craft Yarn Council system)**: 0 lace, 1 super fine (fingering), 2 fine (sport), 3 light (DK), 4 medium (worsted, aran), 5 bulky, 6 super bulky, 7 jumbo; the UK uses "ply" names; the label lists suggested hook size and gauge.
- ☐ **CRO-03.2 Cotton**: firm, washable, good for amigurumi, dishcloths and summer tops; mercerised cotton thread for lace.
- ☐ **CRO-03.3 Wool**: warm, springy, can felt; merino is soft; superwash wool survives machines.
- ☐ **CRO-03.4 Acrylic**: cheap, washable, many colours; does not breathe and sheds microplastics (CRO-15.3).
- ☐ **CRO-03.5 Blends and other fibres**: bamboo viscose, linen, silk, alpaca, mohair; India's own jute, banana-fibre and khadi yarns.
- ☐ **CRO-03.6 Recycled yarns**: t-shirt yarn ("tarn"), plarn (plastic bag yarn), sari-silk yarn from Indian waste silk.
- ☐ **CRO-03.7 Notions**: stitch markers, tapestry needles, scissors, tape measure, row counter, safety eyes for toys, stuffing, blocking mats and pins, buttons.

PART 3 — STITCHES

About this Part. Every stitch with one or two lines. **US and UK names differ** for the same stitch: a US "single crochet" is a UK "double crochet". Patterns state which system they use; this booklet uses US names with UK names in brackets.

CRO-04 Foundation and basic stitches

☐ CRO-04.1 US and UK stitch names

US name	UK name	Symbol	Abbreviation (US)	Height	Use
Chain	Chain	Oval	ch	Base	Foundation and spaces
Slip stitch	Slip stitch	Dot	sl st	Flattest	Joining, moving along
Single crochet	Double crochet	Plus or cross	sc	1 chain	Dense fabric, amigurumi
Half double crochet	Half treble	T	hdc	2 chains	Quick, warm fabric
Double crochet	Treble	T with one bar	dc	3 chains	Open, fast fabric
Treble (triple) crochet	Double treble	T with two bars	tr	4 chains	Tall, lacy fabric

☐ CRO-04.2 The basics explained

☐ **CRO-04.2a Slip knot and chain**: the first loop and the chain row that starts most work.

☐ **CRO-04.2b Slip stitch**: joins rounds and moves the yarn without adding height.

☐ **CRO-04.2c Single crochet**: insert, yarn over, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through both loops.

☐ **CRO-04.2d Half double, double and treble**: wrap the yarn once or more before inserting the hook, then work off loops two at a time (except the half double, three at once).

☐ **CRO-04.2e Foundation stitches**: chainless foundations (foundation single crochet) for a stretchier edge.

☐ **CRO-04.2f Front loop and back loop only**: working into one loop makes ridges and ribbing.

CRO-05 Textured, post, colourwork and lace stitches

☐ **CRO-05.1 Bobble**: several unfinished double crochets in one stitch, closed together; makes a raised dot.

☐ **CRO-05.2 Puff**: several loops pulled up in one stitch; soft, rounded.

☐ **CRO-05.3 Popcorn**: several complete stitches folded and closed; pops to the front.

☐ **CRO-05.4 Cluster**: stitches worked into several stitches and joined at the top.

☐ **CRO-05.5 Shell and fan**: several stitches in one place, fanning out; the base of many lace edgings.

☐ **CRO-05.6 V-stitch**: a double, chain, double in one stitch.

☐ **CRO-05.7 Bullion**: yarn wrapped many times round the hook; a coil, used in Irish lace.

☐ **CRO-05.8 Crocodile stitch**: overlapping scales.

☐ **CRO-05.9 Post stitches**: worked around the stem of a stitch from the front or back; make cables and crochet ribbing.

☐ **CRO-05.10 Tapestry crochet**: carrying unused colours inside stitches; famous in Colombia's Wayuu *mochila* bags and Guatemala.

☐ **CRO-05.11 Mosaic crochet**: patterns from stitches dropped down over earlier rows; one colour per row.

☐ **CRO-05.12 Intarsia**: separate yarn for each colour block; large pictures with no carried strands.

☐ **CRO-05.13 Lace stitches**: mesh, picot, pineapple, spider, Solomon's knot (love knot).

☐ **CRO-05.14 Tunisian stitches**: simple stitch, knit stitch (looks like knitting), purl stitch, full stitch, honeycomb; worked forward and back on a long hook.

☐ **CRO-05.15 Surface crochet**: chain stitches on top of finished fabric, like embroidery.

PART 4 — TECHNIQUES

CRO-06 Making and finishing

☐ **CRO-06.1 Rows versus rounds**: rows turn at the end; rounds spiral or join; rounds suit hats, toys and squares.
☐ **CRO-06.2 Magic ring (adjustable ring)**: a loop pulled tight to close the centre of a round.
☐ **CRO-06.3 Increasing and decreasing**: two stitches in one to grow; two stitches worked together to shrink (invisible decrease for toys).
☐ **CRO-06.4 Turning chains**: the extra chains at a row's start that match the stitch height.
☐ **CRO-06.5 Changing colours**: finishing the last stitch in the new colour.
☐ **CRO-06.6 Joining**: slip-stitch, single crochet, whip stitch, join-as-you-go for squares.
☐ **CRO-06.7 Weaving in ends**: through stitches in several directions so they do not slip out.
☐ **CRO-06.8 Blocking**: wetting or steaming and pinning work to shape; essential for lace (not for acrylic with heat).
☐ **CRO-06.9 Gauge (tension)**: stitches and rows per 10 cm; make a swatch so garments fit.
☐ **CRO-06.10 Reading patterns**: abbreviations, brackets and repeats, asterisks, stitch counts.
☐ **CRO-06.11 Reading charts**: international symbols (as in Japanese pattern books), read from the centre out for rounds.
☐ **CRO-06.12 Left-handed crochet**: mirror the instructions; charts are reversed.
☐ **CRO-06.13 Edgings and borders**: crab stitch (reverse single crochet), picot edging, shell borders.

PART 5 — STYLES AND TRADITIONS

CRO-07 Styles and traditions of the world and India

☐ **CRO-07.1 Irish crochet lace**: separately made motifs joined with mesh (CRO-00.04).

☐ **CRO-07.2 Filet crochet**: a grid of filled and open squares that makes pictures; easy to chart.

☐ **CRO-07.3 Tunisian (afghan) crochet**: a dense, woven-looking fabric on a long hook.

☐ **CRO-07.4 Broomstick lace**: loops pulled up onto a thick pin (once a broom handle) and worked off in groups.

☐ **CRO-07.5 Hairpin lace**: strips worked on a U-shaped fork and joined; Victorian favourite.

☐ **CRO-07.6 Amigurumi**: Japanese crocheted (or knitted) stuffed toys, worked in tight spirals; *ami* means knitted or crocheted, *nuigurumi* means stuffed doll.

☐ **CRO-07.7 Freeform crochet**: improvised shapes and textures; Prudence Mapstone and James Walters and Sylvia Cosh pioneered it.

☐ **CRO-07.8 Overlay and Bavarian crochet**: overlay builds raised patterns on a base; Bavarian is a dense, two-sided round technique.

☐ **CRO-07.9 Tapestry and Wayuu mochila bags**: the Wayuu women of La Guajira, Colombia and Venezuela; each design carries meaning.

☐ **CRO-07.10 Granny squares**: motifs worked in rounds and joined; 1970s icons, back in fashion in the 2020s.

☐ **CRO-07.11 Crochet art and yarn bombing**: the *Crochet Coral Reef* (Margaret and Christine Wertheim, from 2005), which links crochet and hyperbolic geometry (Daina Taimiņa's crocheted hyperbolic planes, 1997); guerrilla "yarn bombing" of public objects.

☐ **CRO-07.12 India: Narsapur crochet lace**: Andhra Pradesh's West Godavari region; tablecloths, bedspreads and doilies in fine cotton thread; GI tag (registered 2003 to 2004); a women's home industry, mostly exported.

☐ **CRO-07.13 India: Goa and Kerala**: Portuguese-era lace and crochet traditions in Goan Catholic homes; convent schools in Kerala and Goa that taught crochet; church linens and christening robes.

☐ **CRO-07.14 India: everyday crochet**: *crosia* (Hindi word) work in North Indian homes: doilies, TV covers, toran door hangings, purses, baby sweaters; often taught by mothers and grandmothers.

☐ **CRO-07.15 Other traditions**: Turkish *oya* lace edgings (needle, hook and shuttle forms), Philippine and Latin American crochet, Russian and Ukrainian crochet lace.

PART 6 — PROJECTS REGISTER

CRO-08 Projects (register of 24)

Before you start — CRO-08. Level: 1 beginner, 2 easy, 3 intermediate, 4 advanced. Yarn weight by the Craft Yarn Council number. Time is a rough estimate for an average crocheter. Patterns on the website will credit their designers; this register describes, it does not copy.

Project	Family	Level	Yarn (weight, fibre)	Hook (mm)	Time
Dishcloth	Home	1	4, cotton	5	1 to 2 hours
Chain-stitch bracelet	Accessory	1	3 or 4, any	4	30 minutes
Bookmark	Accessory	1	Thread or 1, cotton	2 to 3	1 hour
Plain scarf	Accessory	1	5, wool or acrylic	6 to 8	4 to 8 hours
Coaster set	Home	1	4, cotton	4 to 5	2 hours
Granny square	Motif	2	4, any	4 to 5	30 to 60 minutes per square
Beanie hat (in the round)	Accessory	2	4 or 5, wool	5 to 6	3 to 5 hours
Market or tote bag	Accessory	2	4, cotton	5	4 to 6 hours
Pot holder	Home	2	4, cotton (never acrylic, which melts)	5	2 hours
Basket	Home	2	6, t-shirt yarn or jute	8 to 12	2 to 3 hours
Doily	Home	3	Thread, mercerised cotton	1.25 to 1.75	6 to 15 hours
Simple amigurumi ball or animal	Toy	2	3 or 4, cotton	2.5 to 3.5	3 to 6 hours
Baby blanket	Blanket	2	3 or 4, cotton or baby acrylic	4 to 5	15 to 30 hours
Granny-square blanket	Blanket	2	4, any	5	30 to 60 hours
Corner-to-corner (C2C) blanket	Blanket	2	4, any	5	25 to 50 hours
Fingerless gloves	Accessory	2	3, wool	4	3 to 5 hours
Baby booties	Garment	3	3, cotton or wool	3.5	2 to 4 hours
Toran door hanging	Home (India)	2	Thread or 3, cotton	2 to 3	4 to 8 hours
Mandala wall hanging	Home	2	3 or 4, cotton	4	3 to 6 hours
Granny-square cardigan	Garment	3	4, wool or cotton	5	25 to 40 hours
Summer top	Garment	3	2 or 3, cotton or linen	3 to 4	15 to 30 hours
Filet tablecloth	Home	3	Thread, cotton	1.5	40 hours or more
Irish lace collar	Lace	4	Fine thread, cotton	0.75 to 1.25	20 hours or more
Tapestry mochila-style bag	Accessory	4	3, cotton	2.5 to 3	40 hours or more

PART 7 — HISTORY, PEOPLE AND COMMUNITY

CRO-09 The history of crochet

Year	Event	Where	Why it matters
Ancient	Looping crafts such as nalbinding	Many cultures	Ancestors of crochet and knitting
18th century	Tambour embroidery with a hook spreads to Europe	India, Persia, Turkey, then France	A likely source of the crochet hook
1812	Elizabeth Grant's memoir mentions "shepherd's knitting" (published 1898)	Scotland	Early slip-stitch crochet
1824	First printed crochet patterns in *Penélopé*	Netherlands	Crochet in print
1840s	Mlle Riego de la Branchardière's pattern books	London	Crochet lace in fashion
1844	Crochet taught in Narsapur by missionaries (by local account)	Andhra Pradesh	Start of an Indian lace industry
1845 to 1852	Irish crochet lace as famine relief	Ireland	Craft as survival
1851	Irish crochet shown at the Great Exhibition	London	International fame
1900s to 1930s	Filet crochet and thread crochet magazines	Europe, USA	Doilies and home linens
1960s to 1970s	Granny squares and freeform crochet	Worldwide	Craft as fashion and art
2000s	Amigurumi spreads from Japan; online patterns	Worldwide	Toys and the internet revival
2003 to 2004	Narsapur crochet lace gets a GI tag	India	Protected regional craft
2007	Ravelry, a social site for knitters and crocheters, opens	USA	Global crochet community
2020s	Pandemic crafting boom; crochet on TikTok and Instagram; granny-square fashion	Worldwide	Young crocheters

CRO-10 Designers, artists and community

☐ **CRO-10.1 Historic figures**: Mlle Riego de la Branchardière (pattern author, 1840s to 1880s); the Ursuline nuns of Blackrock; Queen Victoria, who crocheted scarves for soldiers in the Boer War (by tradition).

☐ **CRO-10.2 Designers and teachers**: Lily Chin, Jean Leinhauser, Doris Chan, Annie Modesitt, Robyn Chachula, Dora Ohrenstein, Edie Eckman (stitch dictionaries), Jonathan Hiller, Lucy of Attic24 (colourful blogs), Tamara Kelly (Moogly).

☐ **CRO-10.3 Artists**: Joana Vasconcelos (crochet-covered sculptures), Olek (Agata Oleksiak), Toshiko Horiuchi MacAdam (giant crocheted and knitted playgrounds), the Wertheim sisters (Crochet Coral Reef), Daina Taimiņa (hyperbolic crochet).

☐ **CRO-10.4 Indian makers**: the women lace-makers of Narsapur and their cooperatives; self-help groups across India; Indian crochet designers and teachers online (choose those who credit patterns).

☐ **CRO-10.5 Guilds and communities**: Crochet Guild of America (1994), Crochet Guild of Great Britain (1995), Ravelry (2007), local crochet circles, crochet-alongs (CALs).

☐ **CRO-10.6 Fairs and competitions**: CGOA design competitions, county and state fair crochet categories, India's handicraft fairs (Dilli Haat, Surajkund International Crafts Mela).

☐ **CRO-10.7 Records and big projects**: community blankets and record attempts listed by Guinness World Records; check guinnessworldrecords.com for current holders.

PART 8 — IDEAS: PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND SOCIETY

CRO-11 Crochet and the mind

☐ **CRO-11.1 Mindfulness and well-being**: CRO-00.05; Burns and Van Der Meer (2021).

☐ **CRO-11.2 Hands and the brain**: fine motor skills, counting and pattern logic; crochet in occupational therapy.

☐ **CRO-11.3 Crochet and mathematics**: hyperbolic planes, symmetry in mandalas, counting and multiples.

CRO-12 Crochet, women and society

☐ **CRO-12.1 Craft as women's history**: skills passed between generations, often unrecorded and unpaid; Rozsika Parker's *The Subversive Stitch* (1984) on embroidery and femininity applies here too.

☐ **CRO-12.2 Crochet as livelihood**: Irish famine lace, Narsapur, Wayuu bags; fair pay for makers.

☐ **CRO-12.3 Slow fashion and sustainability**: handmade, long-lasting, repairable; choose natural or recycled fibres; microplastic shedding from acrylic.

☐ **CRO-12.4 Men and crochet**: crochet is for everyone; male designers and sports stars who crochet (the Olympic diver Tom Daley is a well-known knitter).

PART 9 — THE PRACTICAL GUIDE

CRO-13 The first 10 projects

☐ **CRO-13.1 The order**: 1 chain bracelet, 2 dishcloth, 3 coaster set, 4 bookmark, 5 plain scarf, 6 granny square, 7 beanie in the round, 8 tote bag, 9 a small amigurumi ball, 10 a granny-square cushion or baby blanket.

☐ **CRO-13.2 What each teaches**: chains, rows, counting, rounds, increasing, colour change, shaping, joining, finishing.

CRO-14 Troubleshooting

☐ **CRO-14.1 Edges not straight**: count stitches; check the turning chain and last stitch.

☐ **CRO-14.2 Work too tight or loose**: change hook size, relax the hand, check gauge.

☐ **CRO-14.3 Squares curling or rippling**: too few or too many stitches per round.

☐ **CRO-14.4 Holes in amigurumi**: smaller hook, invisible decrease, tighter tension.

☐ **CRO-14.5 Hand pain**: ergonomic hook, breaks, stretches; see a doctor for persistent pain.

CRO-15 Care and selling

☐ **CRO-15.1 Care**: follow the yarn label; hand-wash wool in cool water; dry flat; never hang heavy pieces.

☐ **CRO-15.2 Storage**: clean, dry, with neem leaves or cedar against moths.

☐ **CRO-15.3 Selling handmade ethically**: price for time and materials; credit and respect pattern licences (many designers allow selling finished items, some do not); honest fibre labels; safety standards for children's toys (secure eyes, no small parts for under-3s).

PART 10 — REVIEWS AND VOICES

CRO-16 Critics' Corner: books and voices

☐ **CRO-16.1 Books**: Lis Paludan, *Crochet: History and Technique* (1995); *The Harmony Guides* stitch dictionaries; Edie Eckman, *The Crochet Answer Book* (2005); Japanese crochet pattern books (for example from Nihon Vogue), which use the international chart symbols.

☐ **CRO-16.2 Media**: Ravelry reviews, crochet magazines (*Inside Crochet*, *Interweave Crochet*, *Simply Crochet*), YouTube teachers who show both US and UK terms.

CRO-17 The experts said, I say, and My Review Desk

1. **The pattern, yarn, hook or book in two lines**: what, designer or maker, price (dated).
2. **What others said**: 3 to 5 named views, summarised in my own words, with links.
3. **What I say**: clarity of the pattern, errors found, yarn behaviour, hook comfort, time taken, result.
4. **Who made it**: for bought items, was it fairly made and labelled?
5. **My rating** on a clear five-point scale, and **tags and try-next links**.

PART 11 — NAVIGATION, SOURCES AND NOTES

CRO-18 Tag dictionary and site map

☐ **CRO-18.1 Tags**: #crochet #hooks #yarn #cotton #wool #acrylic; stitch tags (#singlecrochet #bobble #shell #tunisian); style tags (#irishcrochet #filet #amigurumi #grannysquare #tapestry #freeform #narsapur); project tags (#blanket #toy #bag #garment #doily); level tags (#beginner #intermediate #advanced); theme tags (#history #mindfulness #sustainability #women #india).

☐ **CRO-18.2 Cross-links**: Knitting (KNT), Embroidery (EMB) and Sewing (SEW) in the Needle Arts branch; Technology (textile technology: TEC-07); Movies and Books (craft in stories); the Curriculum Index (Home Science, Art and Craft, Mathematics of patterns).

☐ **CRO-18.3 Web addresses**: /crochet/ (home, Gateway), /crochet/one-hook-one-string/<leaf>/ , /crochet/tools/<tool>/ , /crochet/yarn/<fibre-or-weight>/ , /crochet/stitches/<stitch>/ , /crochet/techniques/<technique>/ , /crochet/styles/<style>/ , /crochet/projects/<project>/ , /crochet/history/<era>/ , /crochet/people/<name>/ , /crochet/ideas/<topic>/ , /crochet/guide/<topic>/ , /crochet/reviews/<item>/ .

☐ **CRO-18.4 Search phrases to own**: "crochet for beginners step by step", "US vs UK crochet terms", "crochet hook size chart mm", "how to read crochet charts", "granny square pattern beginner", "amigurumi for beginners", "Narsapur crochet lace", with Hindi lines ("crosia kaise bunte hain", "crosia ke design", "crosia ki suii ka size").

CRO-S Sources and credits

☐ **Bodies and museums**: Craft Yarn Council (yarn-weight and hook standards, craftyarncouncil.com); Crochet Guild of America; Victoria and Albert Museum, London (lace collections); National Museum of Ireland (Irish crochet lace).

☐ **Books and research**: Lis Paludan, *Crochet: History and Technique* (1995); Pauline Turner on crochet history; Rozsika Parker, *The Subversive Stitch* (1984); Burns and Van Der Meer, *Perspectives in Public Health* (2021); Daina Taimiņa, *Crocheting Adventures with Hyperbolic Planes* (2009).

☐ **India**: GI Registry, Chennai (Narsapur crochet lace); Development Commissioner (Handicrafts); state handicraft corporations.

CRO-E Editor's notes (corrections and decisions on the brief)

1. **US and UK stitch names** are both given, because they cause most beginner confusion.
2. **Crochet's origins** are presented as unknown, with the main theories and the 1824 first printed patterns.
3. **"Crochet machines"** are corrected: true crochet is handmade.
4. **The Narsapur 1844 story** is marked as local account; the GI tag is official.
5. **Records** are pointed to Guinness World Records rather than stated, since they change.
6. **Added beyond the brief**: hyperbolic crochet and maths, yarn bombing, toy-safety rules, pattern licences, and acrylic microplastics.

CRO-T My Crochet Tracker

Tick ☐ as you learn each stitch and finish each project. Keep a project log: date, project, pattern and designer, yarn, hook, hours, what I learned.

Progress tracker

Part	Sections	Explored ☐	Started	Finished
PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: HOW CAN ONE HOOK AND ONE STRING MAKE LACE, TOYS AND BLANKETS?	7			

PART 1 — THE MASTER MAP OF CROCHET	1			
PART 2 — TOOLS AND MATERIALS	2			
PART 3 — STITCHES	2			
PART 4 — TECHNIQUES	1			
PART 5 — STYLES AND TRADITIONS	1			
PART 6 — PROJECTS REGISTER	1			
PART 7 — HISTORY, PEOPLE AND COMMUNITY	2			
PART 8 — IDEAS: PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND SOCIETY	2			
PART 9 — THE PRACTICAL GUIDE	3			
PART 10 — REVIEWS AND VOICES	2			
PART 11 — NAVIGATION, SOURCES AND NOTES	4			